MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
5th SEMESTER
BBA/B.Sc. Psychology (Honours) Regular Examination
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC):
MG5DSCPSY301 – INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR IN ORGANIZATION
Max mark: 50 **Max Time: 1.5 hours**

Part A
Answer all. Each question carries 1 marks

1.Networked organizations are made possible largely through(U/CO1)

b) Technology

2. A manager enjoys brainstorming and develops new ideas by reflecting on previous experiences. Which Kolb style best describes this manager? (A/CO1)

a) Diverger

3. Workforce restructuring may involve (U/CO3)
a) Changing the number, structure, or distribution of jobs in an organization

4.. One reason expatriates may fail is their inability to (U/CO1)

b) Adapt to a new culture

5. According to Carl Jung's framework for cognitive styles, how do individuals who prefer Sensation gather information? (U/CO2)

b) Through hard facts

6. Distributive justice concerns the fairness of (U/CO3)

c) Outcomes

7. A company faces a major economic crisis and considers several completely new strategies. The consequences of each strategy are highly uncertain. This is most likely a (A/CO3)
d) Adaptive decision

8. Which statement is TRUE about research on typical and maximum performance? (U/CO3)

(b) Research generally supports the distinction between ability-driven maximum performance and ability-plus-motivation typical performance.

9. Which competency involves planning ahead, working systematically, following procedures, and delivering quality results? (U/CO3)

b) Organizing and executing

10. An HR manager rejects a hiring practice because she believes it would be unfair if she were the applicant being evaluated. Which principle is guiding her decision? (A/CO3)

a) Golden Rule

(10x1=10)

Part B

Answer any 2.Each question carries 5 marks

11. Explain the nature and interdisciplinary character of Organizational Behaviour. .(U /CO1)

Organizational Behaviour (OB) is the study of how people act, think, and feel inside workplace organizations. Its nature is practical and evidence-based—it helps managers understand human behavior to solve real workplace problems, improve employee performance, and increase job satisfaction. OB looks at behavior at three levels: Individual (personality, learning), Group (teamwork, leadership), and Organization (culture, structure). It is also flexible (contingent), meaning there is no single "best way" to manage people; the right approach depends on the situation. OB has an interdisciplinary character because it borrows ideas from several social sciences like Psychology: Gives insights into individual personality, perception, learning, and motivation.Sociology: Helps explain group behavior, team dynamics, organizational structure, and culture.Social Psychology: Explains communication, attitude changes, and decision-making in teams.Anthropology: Helps us understand cross-cultural differences and global work environments.Political Science: Explains workplace power, office politics, and conflict resolution.

(definition 1mark,nature 2 and interdisciplinary 2 mark)

12. Explain the major factors that contribute to individual differences in personality. .(U /CO2)

Individual differences mean that every employee is unique in how they think, feel, and behave at work. Personality is the stable set of characteristics that determines how a person reacts to different situations. Personality is formed by two main forces: Nature (Heredity) and Nurture (Environment).

Biological & Heredity Factors (Nature): Genes inherited from parents play a major role in shaping physical traits, temperament, energy levels, and brain function. Research shows that genetics account for about 50% of personality differences.

Environmental Factors (Nurture): A person's upbringing, family values, school education, peer groups, and societal culture shape their habits and moral beliefs. For example, people raised in individualist cultures value personal independence, while those in collectivist cultures value group teamwork.

Situational & Learning Experiences: Life experiences, career changes, and continuous learning help refine and stabilize a person's personality traits over time.

(intro 1 mark-any two factors two mark each)

13. Explain Decision by Experts and Decision by Averaging Individual's Opinions as Group/Team Decision-making techniques. .(U /CO3)

(Intro 1 mark two mark each for each technique)

In team decision-making, when full group discussion is not possible or time is limited, teams use these two non-discussion techniques:

Decision by Experts: The team hands over the entire decision to one member who has the most technical knowledge or experience in that area.

It is fast and works very well for complex technical problems.

Disadvantages: Finding the true expert can be difficult, and if the wrong person is picked, a poor decision is made. Other team members may also feel left out.
Decision by Averaging Individual's Opinions: The leader collects individual ratings, scores, or votes from each member separately (through forms or messages) and calculates the average score to make the final decision without a live group meeting.
It saves time, stops loud members from dominating, and gives everyone an equal say.
Disadvantages: There is no group debate to create new ideas, and expert opinions get the exact same weight as beginner opinions

14. Differentiate job rotation, job enlargement, and job enrichment in terms of how each changes a job.(U /CO2)
Job design defines how work tasks are structured, and organizations use job rotation, job enlargement, and job enrichment to reduce employee boredom and boost motivation. **Job rotation** changes a job by horizontally moving an employee from one simple task to another at set times (such as moving a fast-food worker from cooking fries to operating the cash register) without changing task difficulty or worker authority, which reduces physical fatigue and creates a multi-skilled workforce. **Job enlargement** expands the horizontal scope of a job by adding more tasks of the same skill level to a worker's daily routine (such as asking a typist to also answer phones and greet visitors), which increases task variety and breaks single-task monotony but gives the worker no extra decision-making power. In contrast, **job enrichment** expands the vertical depth of a job by giving the employee higher responsibility, freedom, and decision-making control (such as allowing a factory worker to plan their own schedule, assemble the entire product, inspect quality, and speak with suppliers), which directly satisfies growth needs, builds self-confidence, and creates high internal work motivation and job satisfaction.

15. Explain how learning takes place through Online Training. (K/CO2)
Online training (or E-Learning) is a digital instruction system where trainers and trainees are physically separated, and lessons are delivered using computers, smartphones, videos, and Learning Management Systems. Learning happens online through four simple step-by-step processes: first, complex courses are broken into short lessons followed by quick quizzes, where receiving immediate digital feedback acts as positive reinforcement to help students quickly correct mistakes and lock in knowledge; second, by combining written text with audio, diagrams, and videos, online modules engage both logical and visual brain processing, making difficult concepts easier to understand; third, trainees learn through observation by watching video demonstrations of experts performing skills, which builds self-efficacy and confidence before attempting the task on the job; and finally, learners go through a complete experiential cycle by watching scenario videos, participating in online discussion forums, reading digital materials, and testing their skills in interactive exercises, allowing them to learn at their own comfortable pace.
(Students are either free to write similar to scheme or using examples)

16. Explain Delphi Technique as a decision-making generating alternative technique. .(U /CO3)
The Delphi Technique is a structured group decision-making method used to solve complex problems by gathering expert opinions through sequential questionnaires, with the unique feature that the experts never meet face-to-face. It was specifically created to overcome

common meeting problems—such as dominant bosses controlling the room, loud personalities, and the fear of disagreeing with senior staff (groupthink)—by keeping every participant's answers completely anonymous throughout the process. The method begins when a central leader selects a panel of experts and sends them a first questionnaire to collect initial ideas anonymously; the leader collects and summarizes these responses into a report, then sends a second questionnaire where experts rate and score all the generated alternatives; through two to three iterative rounds of scoring and feedback, experts adjust their ratings based on group averages until a common agreement (consensus) is reached, producing a high-quality, expert-driven decision without incurring travel costs or suffering from peer pressure.

(5x4=20)

Part C
Answer any 2.Each question carries 10 marks

17: Define social, emotional, and appreciative intelligence and explain its significance for effective leadership.(U/Co2)
(Each factor 3 marks each and 1 mark for intro and conclu)
Social, emotional, and appreciative intelligence represent three critical interpersonal capabilities that drive effective leadership beyond traditional intellectual ability (IQ). Social intelligence is the ability to perceive, interpret, and understand social dynamics accurately, allowing leaders to adapt their behavior across diverse interpersonal contexts and navigate workplace politics smoothly. Emotional intelligence (EI), popularized by Daniel Goleman and rooted in Salovey and Mayer's framework, is the capacity to monitor, understand, and regulate one's own emotions and those of others through five core dimensions: self-awareness, self-regulation, internal motivation, empathy, and social skills. Appreciative intelligence, developed by Thatchenkery and Metzker, is the ability to perceive the positive, inherent generative potential within a present situation or person, comprising three key components: reframing tasks with purpose, appreciating positive aspects, and seeing how a successful future unfolds from present actions. Together, these three intelligences are vital for effective leadership because they enable managers to handle organizational change and employee anxiety during crises, build trust across multicultural teams, resolve interpersonal conflicts, and create positive self-fulfilling prophecies that inspire innovation and peak performance.

18: Explain Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory of Motivation. How does its contribution to work motivation apply in a work setting? (A/Co3)
(Explaining the theory fetches 5 marks and application 5 marks)
Frederick Herzberg's Two-Factor (or Motivator-Hygiene) Theory asserts that job satisfaction and job dissatisfaction are driven by two entirely separate sets of workplace factors rather than existing on a single continuous scale. Hygiene factors pertain to the job context or working environment—such as company policies, technical supervision, physical working conditions, base salary, job security, and interpersonal relationships—and serve a preventive role; improving them eliminates employee dissatisfaction and brings morale to a neutral baseline, but does not actively inspire superior performance. In contrast, motivators relate

directly to job content and the nature of the work itself—including achievement, recognition, challenging assignments, increased responsibility, advancement, and personal growth—which satisfy higher-level growth needs and generate genuine internal motivation and job satisfaction. In a practical work setting, managers must apply this theory through a two-step approach: first, they must manage hygiene factors by providing fair compensation, safe working environments, and equitable policies to remove grievances and prevent turnover; second, once baseline hygiene is established, they must implement vertical job enrichment by delegating decision-making autonomy, offering meaningful recognition, structuring complete work modules, and providing clear career growth paths to drive long-term productivity and engagement.

19: Discuss the professional skills required by managers at different levels of the organizational hierarchy. (U/Co1)
(Some students may write only Henry Mintzberg identified **ten distinct roles** that managers perform, which are grouped into three primary categories: interpersonal, informational, and decisional .)
Managerial effectiveness across an organizational hierarchy relies on a balanced combination of four core professional skills identified are **: technical skills** (applying specialized methods, tools, and procedures**), interpersonal (human) skills** (working effectively with people, motivating teams, and resolving conflict), **conceptual skills** (viewing the organization as an interconnected whole, analyzing complex environments, and engaging in strategic planning), and **communication skills** (clearly conveying thoughts and actively listening, which underpins all managerial interactions). The relative importance of these skills varies significantly across the three main levels of the corporate hierarchy: first-line managers (supervisors) require high technical skills to train operational employees, inspect work quality, and solve daily technical problems, paired with strong interpersonal skills to handle routine worker concerns; middle managers (department heads) serve as a crucial bridge between executive vision and operational execution, relying heavily on interpersonal and communication skills to coordinate cross-functional teams alongside moderate conceptual skills to translate strategy into action; and top-level executives (CEOs) depend primarily on high conceptual skills to navigate environmental uncertainty, make long-range strategic choices, and shape organizational vision, while relying on staff experts for day-to-day technical execution.

(10x2=20)